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Fearing AI, parents take pictures of kids offline

Anxiety deepens over use in explicit images

By Janelle Nanos
GLOBE STAFF

As back-to-school season kicked off this year, social media was once again awash in a flood of photos of grinning kids with backpacks. But this time, a current of anxiety was also coursing through the web.

“Mom to mom, I am begging you to reconsider posting pictures of your children on your social media,” one lifestyle blogger pleaded.

“You should NEVER post pictures of your children online. LIKE EVER,” an AI ethicist warned.

“EFFECTIVE IMMEDIATELY,” a family photographer announced, “I will no longer be posting identifiable images of children.”

Debates about digital privacy and the hazards of putting children’s faces online have been taking place for decades, ever since Philippe Kahn instantly shared the first camera phone photo of his newborn daughter from the delivery room in 1997. A subset of parents already blur their kids’ faces, use emojis to cover them, or keep photos offline entirely.

But now, the rise of AI-generated explicit images and a recent, somewhat counterintuitive, federal court ruling have heightened the stakes.

“There were dangers about it from the get-go,” said Jenn Adams, a Burlington, Vt.-based family photographer. “This has only elevated it exponentially.”

The discussion was largely predicated on a federal appeals court ruling out of the Seventh Circuit late last month, which found that un-

PHOTOS, Page A7

In concert business, it’s still profits over politics

By Mark Shanahan
GLOBE STAFF

Did something change when Robert Kraft got Macklemore removed from Ed Sheeran’s tour?

For example, when Gorillaz performs at TD Garden next week, will singer Damon Albarn raise a Palestinian flag, as he sometimes does on stage, or has Albarn been warned not to by the venue or Live Nation, the show’s promoter?

And when Noah Kahan, the New England native who’s one of the biggest musical acts in the world, announces a 2027 summer tour of

► **Ticketholders for Sheeran’s Gillette shows must act fast for refunds. B8.**

select US stadiums, will it include a date at Gillette Stadium or will Kahan, perhaps unhappy with Kraft’s intervention in Sheeran’s show in Foxborough, opt to perform elsewhere?

Time will tell, but most music industry observers agree that profit, not politics, is king in the concert business and the uproar over Kraft and Macklemore will quickly fade. Ultimately, they say, promoters, venues, and artists are all motivated by money and thus disinclined to do anything that might hurt their bottom line, even if it means overlooking speech or behavior they object to.

“It’s a risky proposition for a public person to engage in meaningful debate on a contentious issue in 2026,” said David Herlihy, a songwriter and transactional entertainment lawyer who teaches at Northeastern. “Neil

GILLETTE, Page A9



MARK STOCKWELL FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE/FILE

From promoters to artists, everyone is wary of hurting the bottom line.

Storm a reminder of city’s vulnerability

This isn’t the big one, but Boston has a lot to do for the future — and it’ll cost

By Kate Selig
and Niki Griswold
GLOBE STAFF

New England is scheduled to be hit with the first big Atlantic storm of the season beginning later Friday, a powerful nor’easter projected to bring strong winds and up to 6 inches of rain in spots and the threat of widespread coastal flooding.

Though Boston isn’t expected to

bear the brunt of it, a storm of this potential could test preparations in a city that is one of the most vulnerable in the country to flooding. Nor’easters have inundated low-lying waterfront neighborhoods, a harbinger of greater threats to come as climate change drives rising seas and stronger storms.

The US Army Corps of Engineers has a \$10 billion draft plan to armor

the coastline that could make catastrophic floods a thing of the past. But funding for the plan is still an open question, and completion of the projects could be decades away.

In the meantime, some worry that Boston is a sitting duck for the next generation of powerful storms.

“We’re fundamentally unprotected and highly vulnerable,” said Marc Margulies, an architect and president of the Wharf District Council.

Since 1991, the city has weathered more than a dozen storms with flooding severe enough to trigger fed-

eral or state disaster declarations. Many point to an epic nor’easter that pounded the region in March 2018 as evidence.

The tide reached nearly 15 feet, flooding streets in East Boston, low-lying sections of Dorchester, and downtown, as well as Fort Point and the Seaport, where tidal surges submerged the decks of luxury waterfront condos. Storm water poured through the roof of the Aquarium station on the MBTA’s Blue Line and overcame a sea wall in the North

FLOODS, Page A8

‘Historically, we never paid attention to rats when we designed parks.’

NATHAN HINCHLIFFE, *Boston’s director of parks maintenance and operations*

Ratting them out

Rodent fighters from around the world meet in Boston to refine their strategies



By Spencer Buell
GLOBE STAFF

There is, among the trained killers and thinkers assembled here this week for the nation’s premier anti-rodent event, some begrudging respect for the rat.

Here is a creature that has thrived alongside us for thousands of years, gnawing through our walls, shimmying under our doors, and plotting against us with what rodentologists call “diabolically clever” minds.

“We are still, for the most part, struggling with this mammal,” said Dr. Bobby Corrigan, the world-renowned New York City rat expert, in a speech opening the proceedings in Boston on Wednesday. “But we’re making progress. Progress is pointing in the right direction.”

It was the start of the second-ever National Urban Rat Summit, set to be held in Boston over two days, where people at the top of their field have been assembled to trade tips on how to stay one step ahead of the wily rodents squirming in our ceilings and under our feet.

You might think Boston wouldn’t want to be associated with anything called a “Rat Summit.” It certainly does not

RATS, Page A9



PHOTOS BY KEN MCGAGH FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

At top, the National Urban Rat Summit gave Brendan Conlon of Boston’s Inspectional Services Department a chance to demonstrate how to shoot carbon monoxide into a rat burrow on Boston Common. Above, one emerged on the Common while the session was going on.

Lawsuits tie weight-loss drugs to a rare type of blindness

Scientists emphasize more studies needed

By Allyson Chiu
GLOBE STAFF

As GLP-1 medications continue to increase in popularity, there are growing concerns that some people who take the weight-loss drugs might be at risk of losing their vision, though experts say that risk appears to be very low.

In recent months, dozens of people have sued makers of widely used GLP-1s, claiming that the medication caused sudden and often permanent blindness. Many of the lawsuits allege that the drugs are linked to a rare condition

called nonarteritic anterior ischemic optic neuropathy, or NAION, which causes damage to the optic nerve.

A Dedham resident said he had been taking Ozempic for about a year when he lost vision in both eyes, according to a complaint filed in district court in Pennsylvania. In another court filing, an Easthampton resident claimed he experienced vision loss in his left eye after taking Wegovy. The complaints are part of a multidistrict lawsuit, which includes more than 200 cases.

Ozempic and Wegovy are both made by Danish pharmaceutical company Novo Nordisk and use semaglutide, part of a class of drugs that slow digestion and

GLP-1, Page A8

Three news organizations banned from the White House were back after a judge gave CNN, MS NOW, and Politico a reprieve. **A2.**

The Methuen Retirement Board voted to strip former police chief Joseph Solomon of his nearly \$184,000 annual pension, after he pleaded guilty to 17 public corruption charges. **B1.**

Massachusetts’ gambling regulators will examine how DraftKings and other betting companies that operate in the state use AI. **B8.**

Eight sailors attempted suicide while deployed with the USS Abraham Lincoln for a record time. **A4.**



Fall’s teeth

Friday: Rain, wind moving in. High 61-66. Low 55-60.

Saturday: Get used to it. High 58-63. Low 54-59.

Sunrise: 6:35 Sunset: 6:36

Weather and Comics, G6-7.

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